



free will
and
determinism

A large, solid orange circle with a subtle drop shadow, centered on a white background. Inside the circle, the text "against compatibilist free will" is written in white, bold, lowercase letters, arranged in three lines.

**against
compatibilist
free will**

against
incompatibilist
free will

1. Isabel is responsible for poisoning the coffee.
2. If Isabel is responsible for poisoning the coffee, then her act of poisoning the coffee is free.
3. Isabel's act of poisoning the coffee is free.
(1,2)
4. Isabel had no choice about the chip being inserted into her brain.
5. The chip being inserted into Isabel's brain necessitates that she will poison the coffee.

- C. An act can be free even if it is necessitated by facts about which the agent has no choice.
(3,4,5)

THE FRANKFURT ARGUMENT

This looks like a powerful argument against the No Choice/Necessitation Principle. It also looks like a powerful argument for compatibilism, since it is hard to see why, if freedom actions can be necessitated by stuff outside of your control, free action would **not** be compatible with its being necessitated by the past and the laws of nature.





3. Isabel's act of imprisoning the confessor is free.

4. Isabel had no choice about the chip being

by facts about which the agent has no choice.

cofice, then her act of poisoning the cofice is

neccessitates that she will provide.

inspired their brain.

1. Isabel is responsible for providing the coffee.

(1, 2)

Crucial Anticancer Agent

(3, 4, 5)

5. The chip being inserted into Isabel's brain



2. If Isabel is responsible for poisoning the



outside of your control, free action would not be compatible with its

This looks like a powerful argument against the No Choice/Necessitation

Principle. It also looks like a powerful argument for compatibilism, since

it is hard to see why, if freedom actions can be necessitated by stuff

being necessitated by the past and the laws of nature.

We can lay out this puzzle in terms of the following master argument against the

reality of free will.



Wili.

1. Free will is incompatible with determinism.

0. There is no fire in.

2. If Libertarianism is true, there is no free





believe in free will rejects premise (2).

Compatibility believer in free will rejects premise (1). An incompatibilist

Now, so far we have been given no reason to think that either premise (2)

for (2), and one for (3).

or premise (3) is true. We're now going to look at two arguments — one



1. No one has any choice about events which

future is not as it was with the state of the

happened in the distant past.



3. If determined, the only one

4. If determinism is true, the laws of

varlatatie + the last of the

2. None has any choice about DIDS. ATJR.

nature say that if DINS ARE happy,

6. If $\det A$ is true, then A has any

theorie about the fact that if DNR

C. If determinist is true, then no one has any

then DECISION. (4,5)

if P , then Q , then one has any choice

choice about DECISION (2, 6, 7)

of interest.

about whether @.

and none has any choice about whether,



5. No one has any choice about what the laws

~ If none has about choice about whether P,

then DECISION happens. (3)

rules out free will.

This argument seems to show that the

one has any choice about the past, no

choice principle, and determinism

choice about the laws of nature, then no

combination of four - that No

hence that free will is incompatible with

seem quite plausible, the argument

seems to show that if determinism is

Since the first three of these theses

true, there are no free actions — and







2. If Libertarianism is true, there is no free

Wili.

0: There is no fire will.

1. Freewill is incompatible with determinism.





Real/|the master argument:

in free will, and find the consequent argument persuasive, it looks

tempting to reply to the master argument by denying premise (2).

The consequence argument is a defense of premise (1). If you believe

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A large red circle with a slight drop shadow, containing white text. The text is arranged in three lines, centered within the circle.

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